

Andres Aguilar

Curriculum Vitae

Biologist | (559) 679-8636 | aagu2002@gmail.com | aaguilar120@csustan.edu

Education

Masters of Science, Biology

California State University, Stanislaus
Expected graduation date: May 2027

Present

Bachelors of Science, Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

University of California, Merced

Dec. 2024

Awards and Scholarships

Graduate Teaching Fellowship (\$20,000)	2025, 2026
California Grassland Research Awards for Student Scholarship (\$500)	Spring 2026
Outstanding Graduating Senior Award	Fall 2024
Swarth-Fogel NRS Undergraduate Research Scholarship (\$500)	Spring 2024
Ann Reimer's Foundation Scholarship (\$1,200)	Fall 2023
Booth Family Scholarship (\$1,500)	2020, 2021, 2023
Dean's List, University of California Merced	Fall 2020

Publications

Applegate, A., A. Aguilar, A. Ayan, M.S. Ortiz. 2023. Postfire habitats influence mammalian land use patterns. *California Ecology and Conservation*, Spring 2023 Vol. 7 Issue 1.
[doi: 10.21973/N3PD5J]

Presentations

Aguilar, A. (2026). *Using Predator Gut Content eDNA to Improve Detection of Ambystoma californiense in Seasonal Wetlands*. Swarth-Fogel Research Symposium, University of California Merced.

Aguilar, A. (2025). *Life history observations of the rare stonefly Mesocapnia bulbosa in Corral Hollow, an intermittent stream in the Diablo Range*. California Aquatic Bioassessment Workgroup and CA Chapter of the Society of Freshwater Science Annual Meeting.

Aguilar, A. (2025). *Creating Opportunities for High School Students in Tulare County to Assist in Long Term Oak Tree Monitoring*. Better Grasslands Through Knowledge: A CNGA Science-Based Symposium, California Native Grasslands Association.

Aguilar, A. (2025). *Pursuing Graduate School and Life After Graduation*. Ecology Field And Lab Lecture, University of California Merced.

Aguilar, A. (2023). *Postfire Habitats Influence Mammalian Land Use Patterns*. California Ecology and Conservation Final Symposium, UC Natural Reserve System.

Media & Reports

Aguilar, A. (2025). Featured on *California Water Quality Monitoring Council* youtube for presenting at the California Aquatic Bioassessment Workgroup Meeting (CABW). [Mesocapnia Bulbosa presentation](#)

Aguilar, A. (2024). Featured in *Tulare Office of Education Annual Report 2023-2024* for contributions to the Long-term Oak Forest Inventory (LOFI) and for representing the University of California Merced at SCICON's Wildflower Festival. A copy is available upon request.

Research Experience

Masters Thesis, *California State University Stanislaus* **Aug. 2025 - Present**

Project: Molecular Evidence of Invertebrate Predation of Amphibians

- Build and conduct scientifically rigorous study
- Coordinate with State agencies and permitted researchers
- Effectively communicate my work to agencies and committee

Graduate Research Project, *California State University Stanislaus* **Aug. 2025 - Jan. 2026**

Project: *Life history observations of the rare stonefly Mesocapnia bulbosa*

- Measure M. bulbosa growth over time using microscope
- Analyze the effects of environmental covariates on larval growth
- Generate a presentation for a 15 minute lightning talk on findings

Oak Tree Health Study, *UC Merced - Circle J. Norris Ranch*

Independent Research Project **Jun. 2023 - Jan. 2025**

- Received funding through the Swarth-Fogel NRS Undergraduate Research Scholarship
- Working with Tulare County Office of Education
- Analyzing 5 years worth of data collections

California Ecology and Conservation field course, *UC Natural Reserve System* **Spring 2023**

Project: Postfire habitats influence mammalian land use patterns

- Extracted scat samples from a multitude of burned and unburned areas
- Examined contents within scat using hand lenses
- Data Analysis
- Final project presentation

Volunteer Research Assistant, *The Sexton Lab, UC Merced* **Aug. 2022 - Dec. 2023**

Ph.D. Candidate, Daniel Toews. Environmental Systems Sciences

Project: Vernal Pool Plant Metabarcoding

- Extracted eDNA from soil samples from various vernal pools
- Conducted PCR testing with samples
- Assisted in library prep for dissertation

Research Intern, *Booth Ranches LLC*

Jul. 2020 - Apr. 2023

- Chemical inventory and collection
- Field data collection
- Pest recording and identification

Skills

- Field research techniques
 - Both aquatic and terrestrial ecosystem experience
 - Biological instructor
 - DNA extractions
 - Protocol analysis and interpretation
 - Fluent in english and spanish
 - Aquatic California Tiger Salamander Surveying
 - Research Presentation Skills
 - Public Speaking Experience
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Work Experience

Graduate Teaching Fellow, California State University, Stanislaus

Jan. 2026 - Present

Staff Biologist, *Bancroft Construction Services*

Jan. 2025 - Present

Student Assistant, *Merced Vernal Pools Grasslands Reserve*

Feb. 2024 - Jan. 2025

Student Assistant, *Graduate Division*

Nov. 2023 - Feb. 2024

Student Tour Guide, Office of Admissions

Aug. 2022 - Oct. 2023

Agriculture Intern, *Booth Ranches LLC.*

Jul. 2020 - Apr. 2023

Academic References

Dr. Daniel Toews

Conservation Project Manager

The Nature Conservancy

Phone: (209) 628-8915

Email: daniel.toews@tnc.org

Relationship: Personal Mentor and Former Lab Supervisor

Dr. Matthew Hutchinson

Professor of Biology

University of California, Merced

Email: mhutchinson6@ucmerced.edu

Relationship: Previous Professor and NSF GRFP Mentor

Dr. Matthew Cover

Professor of Biology

California State University, Stanislaus

Email: mcover@csustan.edu

Relationship: Principal Investigator